words, just as ‘the West’ is more a state of mind and not a mere geography, ‘the Middle East’ too is a state of mind.

The dichotomous approach of postcolonial thought to European colonialism and Middle Eastern colonialism may be attributable to the influence of its Palestinian connection, or the fact that Middle Eastern consciousness and Indic consciousness are lumped together under the category of the Oriental and are seen as equal victims of European colonialism. In that sense, Orientalism has had the effect of pixelating from public scrutiny the motivations, conduct and impact of Middle Eastern colonialism on the Indic civilisation and its consciousness. It also needs to be said that the attempt to give the impression that Middle Eastern consciousness is native to the Indic civilisational fabric is dishonest and without basis in history. However, that discussion, which requires a deeper examination by experts, is beyond the scope of this book.

For the purposes of the current discussion, what is certainly relevant and sufficient is the recognition that the postcolonial school, while rejecting the tall claims of European colonialism, actively obstructs any honest analysis of Middle Eastern colonialism and its coloniality, thereby allowing it to thrive in Bharat.[5] Given the manifest and significant similarities in the OET frameworks between European and Middle Eastern colonialities, at the very least, postcolonial thought ought to have challenged the latter’s untenable claim of being the final repository of the truth in the same manner and to the same degree as its challenge to the former’s claim of universal validity. After all, both forms of colonialities are significantly inspired by their respective OETs, which enjoin them to colonise, enslave and evangelise idol-worshipping indigenous societies.[6]

Both proceed on the axiomatic presumption that prior to their advent, colonised societies were consumed by darkness and ignorance (called ‘Jahilliya’ in the case of Middle Eastern coloniality), which requires them to spread the ‘light’ of their respective OETs either through force or inducement or both.[7] In fact, their attitudes towards their own respective pre-Christian and pre-Muslim histories are one of contempt and condescension, which are directed at the rest of the world, after their own respective conversions to the ‘true faiths’. As a corollary, both believe in the concept of ‘the true faith’ and heathendom, which ‘others’ and dehumanises the rest of the world at the outset. Both view the lands of the infidel or the heathen, as the case may be, as objects of conquest, an attitude